Sugarcane Farming Handbook

By NOMAD

Sugarcane planting is a detailed process that involves specific environmental conditions, preparation, and maintenance to ensure a high yield. Below is a comprehensive summary of the process:

1. Ideal Growing Conditions

- **Climate**: Sugarcane thrives in tropical and subtropical regions with temperatures between **20°C and 33°C**. It requires a long growing season and is sensitive to frost.
- **Soil**: The best soil is **well-drained loamy or sandy loam** with a pH level between **5.5 and 8.5**. The soil must be well-aerated to prevent waterlogging, which can cause rot.
- **Water**: The crop requires significant moisture, typically **1,500–2,500 mm** of annual rainfall or equivalent irrigation.

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2. Land Preparation

- **Tillage**: Deep plowing (30–45 cm) is necessary to break hardpans and allow for deep root penetration.
- **Soil Improvement**: Applying organic matter like compost or manure (10–15 tons/ha) before planting improves fertility.
- **Layout**: For efficient water management, farmers create **ridges and furrows**.

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3. Planting Techniques

Sugarcane is typically propagated vegetatively using **setts** (cuttings of mature stalks) rather than seeds.

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- **Cuttings**: Each sett should be 30–45 cm long and contain **2 to 3 buds** (eyes).
- **Methods**:

- **Flat Planting**: Setts are placed in shallow furrows (8–10 cm deep).
- **Furrow Planting**: Setts are placed in deeper furrows (10–20 cm) in areas with moderate rainfall but poor drainage.
- **Trench Method**: Setts are planted in deep trenches (20–25 cm), which is highly efficient for tall crops and high-wind areas to prevent "lodging" (falling over).
- **Spacing**: Cuttings are generally spaced **75–150 cm** apart in rows.

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4. Crop Maintenance

- **Watering**: Consistent moisture is critical during germination and the "grand growth" phase. Irrigation should be reduced as the cane matures to concentrate sugar.
- **Fertilization**: Heavy feeding is required, specifically **Nitrogen, Phosphorus, and Potassium (NPK)**.
- **Weed Control**: Early-stage weeding is vital until the canopy closes and naturally suppresses weeds.
- **Cultural Practices**:
- **Earthing-up**: Moving soil from ridges to the base of plants to strengthen roots.
- **Detrashing**: Removing dead bottom leaves to improve airflow and reduce pest risk.
- **Propping**: Tying stalks together to prevent them from falling.

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5. Harvesting and Ratooning

- **Timing**: Maturity is usually reached in **10–18 months**.
- **Method**: Stalks are cut as close to the ground as possible, as the highest sugar concentration is at the base.

- **Ratooning**: After harvest, the roots are left in the ground to grow new shoots called **ratoons**. This allows for multiple harvests (usually 2–3) without replanting.

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- To master sugarcane farming, you must manage its high nutrient and water needs across its 10–18 month lifecycle while staying ahead of specialized pests.

1. Fertilizer & Nutrient Strategy

Sugarcane is a "heavy feeder." For a target yield of 100 tons/ha, the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) recommends approximately **100–200 kg Nitrogen (N)**, **20–90 kg Phosphorus (P)**, and **125–160 kg Potassium (K)**.

Food and Agriculture Organization

- **Growth-Stage Timing**:
- **Basal (At Planting)**: Apply all Phosphorus (P) and a small portion of Nitrogen (N) and Potassium (K) to support early root development.
- **Tillering (30–90 days)**: Apply the bulk of Nitrogen in split doses to encourage shoot growth.
- **Grand Growth (6 months)**: Focus on Potassium to aid sugar recovery and stalk strength.
- **Ripening (Last 2 months)**: **Stop all Nitrogen application.** Low soil Nitrogen is essential to force the plant to store sucrose rather than growing more leaves.
- **Organic Boost**: Use **Press Mud** (a sugar mill byproduct) at 37.5 t/ha or **Farm Yard Manure** (FYM) to improve soil structure and acidity.

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2. Specialized Water Management

A successful crop requires **1,500–2,500 mm** of water annually.

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- **Critical Stages**: The "Grand Growth" phase requires the most water (approx. 1,000mm).

- **Irrigation Methods**:
- **Furrow Irrigation**: Traditional and low-cost but labor-intensive and less efficient.
- **Drip Irrigation**: Highly efficient, saving **40–70% of water** and allowing for "fertigation" (delivering fertilizer through water).
- **The "Drying-Off" Technique**: Reduce water supply 2–4 weeks before harvest to stress the plant, which concentrates sugar in the stalks.

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  ## 3. Pest and Disease Management

  Sugarcane is uniquely vulnerable to "Borers," which tunnel into the stalk and can reduce sugar levels by **45%**.

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- **Key Pests**:
- **Early Shoot Borer**: Causes "dead hearts" (the center leaf dries up) in young plants.
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  Woolly Aphids

- : Suck sap and promote "sooty mold" on leaves.
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  White Grubs

- **/**

  Termites

- : Attack roots and newly planted cuttings (setts).
- **Major Diseases**:
- **Red Rot**: Visible as red blood-like streaks inside the stalk; highly destructive.
- **Smut**: Produces a black, whip-like growth from the top of the plant.
- **Control (IPM)**: Use **Trichogramma cards** (parasitic wasps that kill borer eggs) as a biological alternative to heavy chemical spraying.

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4. Modern Farming & Economics

- **Mechanization**: Large-scale farms use **Mechanical Harvesters** that can process up to 60 tons per hour, compared to a manual worker's 3–5 tons per day.
- **By-products (Profit Centers)**:
- **Bagasse**: Burnt for electricity or used for paper.
- **Molasses**: Fermented for **Ethanol** (biofuel) or Rum.
- **Ratooning**: You can harvest the same plant **2–5 times** (years) without replanting, though sugar yield typically drops slightly with each cycle.

Food and Agriculture Organization +5

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Fertilizer management for sugarcane depends on whether you are starting a new crop (**Plant Crop**) or maintaining existing roots after harvest (**Ratoon Crop**). Ratoon crops generally require **25–50% more Nitrogen (N)** than plant crops because their older root systems are less efficient and the soil has been depleted by the previous cycle.

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Fertilizer Application Schedules

Stage	Plant Crop (New Planting)	Ratoon Crop (After Harvest)
Basal / Start	Apply **100% of Phosphorus (P)** and **50% of Potassium (K)** in the furrows before placing the setts.	Apply **100% of P and K** plus **25% of N** immediately after "stubble shaving" (cutting old stalks to ground level).
Top Dress 1	**45–60 days after planting**: Apply **50% of Nitrogen** to support early tillering.	**30–45 days after ratooning**: Apply **50% of Nitrogen**. This is critical for rapid shoot regrowth.
Top Dress 2	**90–120 days after planting**: Apply the **remaining 50% of Nitrogen** and **50% of Potassium** during the earthing-up process.	**75–90 days after ratooning**: Apply the **remaining 25% of Nitrogen**. Ensure all N is applied before the "Grand Growth" phase.

Key Differences & Tips

- **Nitrogen Timing**: For both crops, all Nitrogen should be finished within **120–150 days**. Applying Nitrogen late in the cycle (after 6 months) will keep the plant growing green leaves instead of storing sugar in the stalk, which ruins your harvest quality.
- **Method of Application**: Always use **Band Placement** (placing fertilizer in a line along the row and covering with soil) rather than "broadcasting" (scattering by hand). Band placement can increase your yield by up to **15–19%** by reducing nutrient loss to the air.
- **Micronutrient Boost**: For ratoon crops, a foliar spray of **Ferrous Sulphate (2.5 kg/ha)** is often recommended 15 days after harvest to prevent "ratoon chlorosis" (yellowing of new leaves).
- **Organic Supplement**: Applying **15 tons/ha of Farm Yard Manure (FYM)** or **Press Mud** can allow you to reduce chemical fertilizer use by **25%** while maintaining the same high yields.

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In the Philippines, sugarcane fertilization and ratoon management are heavily influenced by the Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA) guidelines to maximize both tonnage and sugar content (LKg/TC).

1. Common NPK Commercial Blends in the Philippines

Philippine farmers typically use a combination of "straight" fertilizers and specific "complete" or "compound" blends. Below are the most widely used options for both newly planted and ratoon crops:

- **Complete Fertilizers (14-14-14)**: Often called "Triple 14," this is a standard balanced blend used as a basal application to provide equal parts Nitrogen, Phosphorus, and Potassium during the early stages.
- **Ammophos (16-20-0)**: High in Nitrogen and Phosphorus, it is popular for initial growth and root development, particularly in Phosphorus-deficient soils.
- **Di-Ammonium Phosphate (DAP) (18-46-0)**: Used as a heavy basal dose for new plantings to ensure strong root establishment.
- **Urea (46-0-0)**: The primary source for the high Nitrogen demand during the "Grand Growth" phase.

- **Muriate of Potash (MOP) (0-0-60)**: Essential for the final ripening phase to increase sucrose concentration.
- **YaraMila Series**: Specialized compound fertilizers like

  YaraMila Grower (13-11-21 + 2MgO + 0.2B)
- are increasingly used for high-yield targets because they include micronutrients like Magnesium and Boron.

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2. Guide to Mechanical Stubble Shaving

Stubble shaving is the process of cutting the remaining stalks of the previous crop as close to the ground as possible—or even slightly below it—to stimulate healthy new growth for the ratoon crop.

Scribd

Why It's Essential

- **Promotes Deeper Roots**: Cutting lower forces new shoots to emerge from underground buds, which develop deeper root systems for better nutrient and water uptake.
- **Uniform Sprouting**: Shaving removes old, woody stems that might sprout "aerial shoots" which are weak and prone to falling over.
- **Saves Money**: Proper shaving can be as effective as adding extra bags of DAP fertilizer by ensuring a robust start for the new shoots.

  National Institutes of Health (NIH) | (.gov) +3

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How to Perform Mechanical Shaving

1. **Timing**: Shave within **10–15 days** after harvest. Do not wait for buds to sprout, as shaving after sprouts appear will kill the new growth.
2. **Soil Conditions**: The field should be **dry**. Operating a mechanical shaver in wet soil can uproot the entire stubble clump, ruining your plant stand.
3. **Optimal Depth**: Aim for a depth of **5 cm below the soil surface**. Research shows this depth can increase cane yield by **28–43%** compared to cutting exactly at ground level.

4. **Equipment Settings**: If using a tractor-mounted shaver, maintain a forward speed of **0.8–1.4 m/s** and a disc rotational speed of **600–1,000 RPM** to minimize damage to the stubble.

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3. Integrated Ratoon Management (The "Ratoon Manager")

Modern "Ratoon Manager" machines are now available that perform multiple steps in a single pass:

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- **Stubble Shaving**: Leveling the stalks.
- **Off-barring**: Breaking the "shoulders" of the ridges to loosen compacted soil and improve aeration.
- **Trash Management**: Mulching old leaves back into the soil for organic matter.
- **Fertigation**: Simultaneously applying the basal fertilizer dose directly to the roots.

  Slideshare +1

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Efficient weed control and a clear understanding of production costs are vital for a profitable sugarcane operation, especially in high-production areas like Bukidnon.

1. Recommended Herbicides for Sugarcane

The Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA) and local experts recommend specific active ingredients based on the growth stage of the crop and the type of weed infestation:

Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA)

- **Pre-Emergence (Before weeds sprout)**:
- **Atrazine & Metribuzin**: These are the most common pre-emergence choices to control a broad spectrum of grasses and broadleaf weeds.
- **Diuron**: Often used immediately after planting to provide long-term residual control.
- **Sencor Plus**: A newer selective option noted for providing residual activity for up to 6–7 months.

- **Post-Emergence (Active weed growth)**:
- **2,4-D**: A highly effective selective herbicide specifically for broadleaf weeds.
- **Glyphosate (e.g., Roundup or RunOut)**: A non-selective herbicide used for total vegetation control before planting or in fallow fields. It must be used with caution (e.g., directed spray) in standing cane to avoid crop damage.
- **Velpar (Hexazinone)**: Often applied as an early post-emergent when weeds are vigorously growing.

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2. Cost-Per-Hectare Breakdown (Ratoon Cycle)

For the 2024–2026 crop years, estimated expenses in the Philippines—particularly in Mindanao/Bukidnon—vary based on farm size and management intensity.

- **Total Production Cost**: Typically ranges from **₱60,000 to ₱120,000 per hectare**.
- **Small-scale farms**: ~₱110,000 to ₱125,000 per hectare.
- **Large-scale/Block farms**: Can reach **₱160,000+** when including intensive administrative and milling costs.
- **Key Expense Categories**:
- **Fertilizer**: One of the largest costs, often averaging around **₱179 per Lkg** (50-kg bag) of sugar produced.
- **Labor (Maintenance & Harvesting)**: Includes stubble shaving, weeding, and cutting. Combined labor and crop maintenance can cost approximately **₱519 per Lkg**.
- **Hauling/Logistics**: Transporting cane to mills like **Crystal Sugar** or **BUSCO** in Bukidnon is a significant factor. Hauling cane points and inputs alone can account for 4% of total costs.
- **Profitability Insight**: As of late 2025, farmgate prices for raw sugar stabilized around **₱2,150 to ₱2,300 per Lkg**. High-tonnage farms (100 TC/ha) with high sugar recovery (above 2.0 Lkg/TC) generally remain profitable even with rising input costs.

Since you are likely looking at the **Bukidnon** planting season (which typically follows the milling schedule from **September to May**), timing is everything. For a **Ratoon Crop**, the clock starts the moment the trucks leave for the mill (**BUSCO** or **Crystal**). Here is your week-by-week labor and management schedule to hit that 100+ ton target:

Phase 1: The Wake-Up Call (Weeks 1–4)

- **Week 1: Stubble Shaving & Trash Management.**
- Immediately after harvest, use a mechanical shaver or sharp hoes to cut old stalks 2–5cm below the soil.
- **Trash Blanketing:** Don't burn the leaves! Spread them between rows to conserve moisture and suppress weeds.
- **Week 2: Off-Barring (Lina).**
- Plow away from the cane rows to loosen the soil and cut old, "lazy" roots, forcing the plant to grow vigorous new ones.
- **Week 3: Basal Fertilization.**
- Apply your **14-14-14** or **16-20-0** along the off-barred furrows.
- **Week 4: First Weeding.**
- Spot-weed any hardy grasses that survived the harvest.

Phase 2: The Growth Surge (Weeks 5–16)

- **Week 6–8: First Top Dress (Nitrogen).**
- Apply **Urea** or **Ammonium Sulfate**. This is the "fuel" for the new shoots (tillers).
- **Week 9: On-Barring (Pasandig).**
- Plow the soil back toward the cane rows to cover the fertilizer and stabilize the new shoots.
- **Week 12–14: Final Top Dress & Hilling-Up (Abono/Sanyud).**
- Apply the remaining **Nitrogen** and **Potash (0-0-60)**.
- Follow immediately with **Hilling-up**: Move a large amount of soil to the base of the stalks to prevent "lodging" (falling over) during Bukidnon’s heavy rains.

Phase 3: Maintenance & "Grand Growth" (Month 5–Month 9)

- **Month 5: Detrashing (Lulid).**
- Laborers remove dry bottom leaves. This improves airflow, reduces pests (like rats and borers), and makes the stalks cleaner for the mill.
- **Month 6–8: Pest Scouting.**
- Assign a "Cane Scout" to walk the fields weekly looking for **Top Borers** or **White Grubs**. In Bukidnon, keep an eye out for **Smut** (black whips) and rogue them out immediately.

Phase 4: The Ripening (Month 10–Harvest)

- **Month 10: Stop All Inputs.**
- Stop irrigation and fertilization. You want the plant to feel "stressed" so it converts its energy into sugar (sucrose) instead of height.
- **1 Week Before Harvest: Burning vs. Green Cane.**
- If the mill allows, **Green Cane Harvesting** is better for your soil, but if you must burn, do it 24 hours before cutting to avoid sugar loss.

Summary of Labor Needs (per Hectare)

Task	Man-Days Needed
Stubble Shaving	2–3 (Manual) or 0.5 (Tractor)
Fertilizing (2 rounds)	4–6
Weeding/Herbicide	5–10 (Depending on trash)
Hilling-up/Ploughing	2 (Animal) or 0.5 (Tractor)
Detrashing	8–12

For the **2025–2026 crop year** in Bukidnon, milling operations at **BUSCO Sugar Milling Co.** and **Crystal Sugar Company, Inc.** began in late November 2025 and are currently in full swing as of March 2026.

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1. Quedan (Sugar) Prices and Dividends

The "Quedan" price is the millgate price for a 50-kg bag (Lkg) of raw sugar. Prices have seen some volatility recently due to supply levels and global oil price surges affecting production.

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- **Current Quedan Price**: As of **March 6, 2026**, the prevailing price is **₱2,150.00 per Lkg**.
- **Molasses Dividend**: Recent releases for Batch 1 (covering November 2025 to January 2026) are priced at **₱5,600.00 per metric ton**.
- **Rebates**: Some associations are currently processing rebates of approximately **₱50.00** from earlier in the season.

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2. Hauling Rates and Allowances

Hauling costs in Bukidnon are a major expense, especially with recent warnings about rising fuel prices.

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- **Trucking Allowance**: Both mills offer trucking allowances to help offset transport costs from the field.
- **BUSCO**: Latest updates cover the week ending **February 15, 2026**.
- **CSCI (Crystal)**: Latest updates cover the week ending **January 25, 2026**.
- **General Market Rates**: While specific per-kilometer rates vary by association, manual direct delivery trucking rates in the region generally range between **₱500 and ₱700 per ton** depending on the distance from the mill.

3. Milling Capacity and Logistics

Mill	Daily Milling Capacity	Status Update (March 2026)
BUSCO	**18,000 Metric Tons**	High capacity utilization; expect longer queues.
Crystal (CSCI)	**12,000 Metric Tons**	Operating at maximum capacity to meet seasonal demand.

Pro-Tip for Bukidnon Planters: Always check the **ABSFI (Associated Bukidnon Sugarcane Farmers, Inc.)** or **Bukidnon Sugarcane Industry** social media pages for daily "Milling Summaries" to avoid long truck lines at the mill gates.

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Joining a Planters' Association in Bukidnon is essential for accessing milling schedules, trucking allowances, and SRA benefits. The two major associations are the Associated Bukidnon Sugarcane Farmers, Inc. (ABSFI) (serving BUSCO) and the **United Sugarcane Planters of Bukidnon** (serving Crystal Sugar).

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1. Core Requirements for Membership

To register as a bona fide member, you generally need to submit the following documents to the association's office:

- **Proof of Land Ownership**: A photocopy of your **Land Title (TCT)** or a **Tax Declaration**. If you are leasing, a notarized **Contract of Lease** is required.
- **Barangay Certification**: A certificate from your local Barangay Hall confirming that you are an active sugarcane farmer in the area.
- **Identification**: At least two valid government-issued IDs and recent **1x1 or 2x2 ID photos**.
- **SRA Registration**: You must be a registered sugarcane planter with the Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA).

2. Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR) Compliance

Associations often require you to have a **Certificate of Registration (COR)** from the BIR to process your sugar quedans (receipts). Requirements for the BIR include:

- **NSO/PSA Certified Birth Certificate**.
- **Marriage Contract** (if applicable).
- **Annual Registration Fee**: Typically **₱500.00**.
- **Sworn Statement**: For small farmers (less than 3 hectares or income below ₱300,000), a sworn statement from the Public Attorney's Office may be needed to avail of certain exemptions.

3. Key Benefits of Joining

- **Trucking Allowances**: Member planters receive financial assistance to cover the high cost of hauling cane to the mill.
- **Milling Priority**: Associations help manage the "trucking queue," ensuring your cut cane is milled quickly to avoid weight and sugar loss.

- **Financial Assistance & Rebates**: Access to molasses dividends, social amelioration programs (SAP) for your workers, and scholarship programs for your children.
- **Representation**: Membership gives you a "bigger voice" through federations like the Mindanao Federation of Sugarcane Planters Inc., led by industry advocates like Manuel Antonio Zubiri.

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How to Contact Them

- **ABSFI Office**: Located at the **BUSCO Compound**, Butong, Quezon, Bukidnon. You can reach them at **0917-530-0038**.
- **United Sugarcane Planters of Bukidnon**: Located at the **Crystal Sugar (CSCI) Compound**, North Poblacion, Maramag, Bukidnon.

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For farmers in Bukidnon, the membership fees are relatively low compared to the massive benefits you get in return, especially the educational support for your children.

1. Annual Membership Fees

While specific fees can vary slightly by association (ABSFI vs. United), the standard structure in Bukidnon generally looks like this:

- **Annual Membership Fee**: Approximately **₱500.00 to ₱1,000.00** per year.
- **Dues/Retentions**: Instead of a large upfront cash payment, most associations deduct a small "service fee" or "association due" of around **₱2.00 to ₱5.00 per Lkg** (per bag) from your sugar quedans during the milling season.
- **SRA Monitoring Fee**: A mandatory government fee of approximately **₱0.10 to ₱0.20 per Lkg** is also deducted to fund the Sugar Regulatory Administration's research and extension services.

2. Educational Scholarship Programs (SDEP)

The most popular program is the **Sugar Workers' Educational Assistance Program (SWEAP)**, funded by the Social Amelioration Program (SAP) under the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) and the SRA.

Who is eligible?

- Dependents (children or siblings) of **small sugarcane farmers** (owning 5 hectares or less).
- Dependents of **plantation workers** (the laborers who cut or weed your cane).

Application Process:

1. **Certification**: Obtain a **Certification of Membership** from your Planters' Association (ABSFI or United) and a **Certification of Sugar Production** for the current crop year.
2. **Academic Records**: Provide the student's **Form 138 (Report Card)** with a general average of at least **80–85%** (depending on the specific grant).
3. **Income Tax Return (ITR)**: A copy of the parent's ITR or a **Certificate of Low Income** from the BIR/Barangay.
4. **Submission**: Submit these to the **Planters' Association Office** or the **SRA Extension Office** located at the BUSCO or Crystal compounds.

3. Additional Social Benefits

- **Death Benefits**: Most Bukidnon associations provide a "Burial Assistance" of **₱5,000 to ₱10,000** for members.
- **Calamity Loans**: Small interest-free or low-interest loans are often available if your farm is hit by El Niño or severe flooding.

Pro-Tip: Since it is currently March, many scholarship applications for the **2026–2027 school year** will start opening in **May or June**. I recommend visiting the **ABSFI office in Quezon** or the **United office in Maramag** next week to get the specific application forms.

For the most accurate and up-to-date information on scholarship applications in Bukidnon, you should contact the coordinators at the association offices located directly within the mill compounds.

1. Associated Bukidnon Sugarcane Farmers, Inc. (ABSFI)

ABSFI manages scholarship programs like the **Educational Aid Program (EDAP)** in partnership with the Sugar Industry Foundation Inc. (SIFI).

- **Office Location**: ABSFI Office, BUSCO Compound, Brgy. Butong, Quezon, Bukidnon.
- **Contact Number**: **0917-530-0038** (Globe).

- **Email**: absfi_bukidnon@yahoo.com.
- **Key Contact**: Inquire with the **EDAP Coordinator** or the office staff regarding the **SIFI Scholarship** for the 2026–2027 academic year.

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2. United Sugarcane Planters of Bukidnon Association (USPBA)

This association represents farmers milling at Crystal Sugar and facilitates similar government and foundation-led grants.

- **Office Location**: USPBA Office, Crystal Sugar Company, Inc. (CSCI) Compound, North Poblacion, Maramag, Bukidnon.
- **Contact Method**: Visit their office directly at the mill site for the latest application forms and specific local coordinator details.

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3. Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA) - Bukidnon Mill District

The SRA oversees the **SIDA Scholarship Program** for sugarcane industry workers' children.

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- **Office Location**: SRA-Bukidnon Mill District Office, Maramag, Bukidnon.
- **National SIDA Hotline**: For program-wide inquiries, you can email sida.hrdp@sra.gov.ph.
- **Key Contact**: Look for the **Mill District Officer (MDO)** or the scholarship desk.

Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA) +2

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Important Dates & Tips

- **Application Window**: While the SRA/CHED SIDA Scholarship typically opens applications in **May**, it is best to check in **March** to ensure you have all documentary requirements (like ITR or Certificate of Indigency) ready.

- **Milling Status**: Note that the Bukidnon sugar price is currently listed at **₱2,175.00 per Lkg** as of March 13, 2026, which may influence association processing times due to high activity at the mills.

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- To ensure the student is ready for the **SIDA (Sugar Industry Development Act)** or **SIFI** scholarship applications opening this May/June, here is the essential document checklist:

Student's Personal Documents

- **PSA Birth Certificate**: Original and photocopy.
- **2x2 ID Photos**: At least 4 copies (recent, white background).
- **Report Card (Form 138)**: Certified true copy showing a General Weighted Average (GWA) of at least **80% or 85%** (no failing grades).
- **Certificate of Good Moral Character**: From the current school principal or registrar.
- **Certificate of Enrollment/Admission**: Proof that the student is enrolled or has passed the entrance exam for a partner college/university (usually for courses like Agriculture, Agribusiness, or Engineering).

Parent/Planter Proof of Eligibility

- **Voter's ID or Certification**: To prove residency in the Bukidnon mill district.
- **Proof of Income**: Any **one** of the following:
- Latest Income Tax Return (ITR).
- **BIR Certificate of Tax Exemption** (if the family earns below ₱250k/year).
- **Certificate of Indigency** from the Barangay.
- **Sugar Production Records**: A photocopy of the **Sugar Quedans** or a **Milling Statement** from BUSCO or Crystal from the most recent crop year.
- **Association Certification**: A letter from **ABSFI** or **USPBA** confirming you are an active member in good standing.

Pro-Tips for Success

1. **Course Choice**: SIDA scholarships heavily prioritize **Agriculture-related degrees**. If the student chooses a non-agri course, the slots are much more competitive.
2. **Early Bird**: Visit the **SRA Office in Maramag** or the **ABSFI Office in Quezon** by mid-April. They often have "Pre-Registration" lists before the official national announcement.
3. **Authentication**: Ensure all photocopies are "Certified True Copies" by the issuing office (School or Barangay) as they often reject plain photocopies.

In Mindanao, the **Sugarcane Industry Development Act (SIDA)** and **Sugar Industry Foundation Inc. (SIFI)** scholarship programs primarily partner with **State Universities and Colleges (SUCs)** that offer specialized agricultural and engineering programs.

Sugar Regulatory Administration (SRA)

1. Top Priority Partner Schools in Mindanao

These institutions are the most common partners for SIDA and SIFI grants due to their strong focus on agriculture and technology:

- **Central Mindanao University (CMU)**: Located in Musuan, Maramag, Bukidnon. This is the primary choice for Bukidnon-based planters. It is a known partner for both SIDA scholarship applications and ABSFI-supported programs.
- **University of Southeastern Philippines (USeP)**: Specifically the

  Tagum-Mabini Campus

- , which specializes in Agriculture and Agricultural Engineering.
- **University of Southern Mindanao (USM)**: Located in Kabacan, North Cotabato. Known for its extensive research in agricultural technology and its status as a center of excellence in the region.
- **Mindanao State University (MSU)**:
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  MSU-Marawi

- : For Engineering and specialized sciences.

- **MSU-Naawan**: Often partners for science and technology grants related to the industry.
- **University of Science and Technology of Southern Philippines (USTP)**: Specifically the

  Cagayan de Oro

- and

  Claveria

- campuses (Claveria is highly focused on Agriculture).

  Central Mindanao University +5

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2. Priority Courses for Scholarship Approval

To qualify for the **SIDA-SGP (Sugarcane Industry Development Act Scholarship Grant Program)**, students must generally enroll in one of these four fields:

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1. **Agriculture** (various majors like Agronomy or Soil Science).
2. **Agricultural Engineering** or Mechanics.
3. **Chemical Engineering**.
4. **Sugar Technology**.

3. Important Deadline for AY 2025–2026

The official deadline for the SIDA-SGP application for the upcoming academic year is **July 31, 2025**. However, individual universities like **CMU** often have earlier internal deadlines (e.g., **June 30**) for their scholarship office processing.

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Next Steps: I recommend the student visit the **CMU Office of Admissions** in Maramag or the **ABSFI Office in Quezon** immediately, as they are currently accepting inquiries for the 2025-2026 intake.

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In the Philippines, sugarcane farming utilizes a standardized set of chemical inputs regulated by the Fertilizer and Pesticide Authority (FPA).

1. Fertilizers (Inorganic & Bio)

Fertilizers are the largest expense, with prices updated weekly for regions like Negros and Bukidnon.

- **Common Grades & Prices (Per 50kg Bag, March 2026)**:
- **Urea (46-0-0)**: Primary nitrogen source. Price: **₱1,600.00 – ₱1,889.00**.
- **Complete (14-14-14)**: Balanced nutrition. Price: **~₱1,509.96**.
- **Ammophos (16-20-0)**: For early growth. Price: **~₱1,310.32**.
- **Potash (0-0-60)**: For sugar content. Price: **~₱1,440.16**.
- **DAP (18-46-0)**: For root development. Price: **~₱2,456.52**.
- **Alternatives & Bio-boosters**:
- **Nutrio Foliar Spray**: A biofertilizer that can reduce inorganic nitrogen use by 50%. Cost: **₱350.00** per 100g packet.
- **Bio N**: Soil-charcoal or bentonite-based nitrogen fixer.
- **Application**: Basal application in furrows during planting, followed by top-dressing at 6–8 weeks and 12–16 weeks.

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2. Herbicides (Weed Control)

Weeds can reduce yields by over 25%, making chemical control essential.

- **Pre-Emergence (Before weeds sprout)**:
- **Atrazine & Metribuzin**: Standard for broad-spectrum control.

- **Diuron**: Often used in plantation crops.
- **Post-Emergence (Active weeds)**:
- **2,4-D (e.g., 2,4-D Ester)**: Selective for broadleaf weeds and sedges.
- **Glyphosate (e.g., Roundup, Run Out)**: Non-selective; kills everything it touches. **Run Out 500ml** costs **~₱320.00**.
- **Application**: Use a spray hood/shield to prevent non-selective herbicides from hitting sugarcane leaves.

  Pest Control Philippines +7

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3. Pesticides & Fungicides

- **Insecticides**:
- **Prevathon 5SC**: Common for borer control.
- **Apache 10G**: Granular soil amendment for subterranean pests.
- **Lambda-cyhalothrin (e.g., Zulpac)**: Systemic control for various sucking and chewing insects. Dosage: 1.0–1.5 Tbsp per 16L water.
- **Fungicides**:
- **Benomyl (e.g., Zerin 50 WP)**: Systemic fungicide used for blights and leaf spots. Dosage: 1–2 Tbsp per 16L water.
- **Application**: Scouting should be done weekly; spray only upon noticing signs of pests or disease.

  Fertilizer and Pesticide Authority +3

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4. Foliars & Root Boosters

- **Foliar Sprays**: High-NPK blends (e.g., 19-19-19) are used every 15 days as growth boosters. **Triple 14** can be mixed at 2 Tbsp per 4L of water for foliar use.
- **Root Boosters**: Phosphorus-rich fertilizers like **DAP** or specialized amendments like **Attract Soil Amendment** are standard for early root architecture.

Yara Philippines +4

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Mixing for a 16-liter knapsack sprayer (the standard size in Bukidnon) requires precision. Over-mixing wastes money and can "burn" the cane, while under-mixing won't kill the weeds or pests.

1. The Golden Rule: The "Slurry" Method

Never pour granules or thick liquids directly into the sprayer tank.

1. Fill a small 4L bucket halfway with water.
2. Add your chemical and stir thoroughly with a stick until fully dissolved.
3. Fill the sprayer tank halfway with clean water.
4. Pour the mixture into the tank through the strainer.
5. Top off with water to the 16L mark.

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2. Mixing Guide for Sugarcane Chemicals

Measurements are based on standard Philippine 16-Liter (4-gallon) knapsack sprayers.

Chemical Type	Example Product	Standard Dose (per 16L)	Purpose
Non-Selective Herbicide	**Roundup / Glyphosate**	**8–12 Tbsp** (120-180ml)	Total weed kill before planting.
Selective Herbicide	**2,4-D Ester**	**4–6 Tbsp** (60-90ml)	Kills broadleaf weeds without hitting cane.
Insecticide (Systemic)	**Prevathon / Zulpac**	**1.5–2 Tbsp** (22-30ml)	Stem borers and sucking insects.
Fungicide	**Zerin / Benomyl**	**1–2 Tbsp** (15-30g)	Leaf spot and smut prevention.
Foliar Fertilizer	**Nutrio / Triple 19**	**4–6 Tbsp** (60-90g)	Rapid growth and "greening" boost.
Sticker/Spreader	**S-800 / Triton**	**1 Tbsp** (15ml)	**Essential:** Helps chemical stick to waxy leaves.

3. Application Tips for Bukidnon Weather

- **The "Sticker" Secret**: Sugarcane leaves are waxy. Always add a **Sticker/Spreader** last to your mix. Without it, your expensive chemicals will just bead up and roll off the leaf onto the ground.
- **Spray Timing**: In Bukidnon, spray between **6:00 AM and 10:00 AM**. Avoid spraying after 10:00 AM when the sun is hot, as the "stomata" (pores) of the plant close up, and the chemical won't be absorbed.
- **Water Quality**: Use clean water from a pump or tap. Avoid "linaw" (murky) river water; the silt and dirt in river water can "deactivate" Glyphosate, making it useless.

4. Safety First

- **Direction**: Always spray **with the wind** at your back. Never spray against the wind, or the mist will land on your skin and lungs.
- **PPE**: At a minimum, wear a long-sleeved shirt, pants, boots, and a face mask (even a t-shirt wrapped around your face is better than nothing).

In Valencia and Maramag, agrivet stores like **B-MEG**, **Agway**, and **PACIFICA** carry the standard range of sugarcane inputs. As of **March 2026**, prices in Bukidnon have seen minor adjustments due to the peak milling season.

1. Fertilizer Prices (per 50kg bag)

Most large-scale planters in Bukidnon buy in bulk from distributors, but retail prices in local shops are as follows:

Fertilizer Grade	Common Brands	Retail Price (March 2026)	Application Tip
Urea (46-0-0)	Viking Ship, Swire	**₱1,600.00 – ₱1,889.00**	Apply in split doses; avoid late application to prevent sugar loss.
Complete (14-14-14)	Atlas, Amigo	**₱1,490.00 – ₱1,510.00**	Use as a basal dose to provide a balanced start.

Ammophos (16-20-0)	Amigo, Swire	**₱1,310.00 – ₱1,370.00**	Ideal for acidic Bukidnon soils to boost phosphorus.
Potash (0-0-60)	MOP	**₱1,440.00 – ₱1,550.00**	Apply 3–4 months before harvest to increase LKg/TC.
DAP (18-46-0)	Di-Ammonium Phos	**₱2,450.00 – ₱2,550.00**	Best for root boosting; apply directly in the furrow.

2. Herbicides (per Liter)

Weed management is critical in Bukidnon's wet climate to prevent grass from "choking" young ratoons.

- **Roundup (Glyphosate)**: **₱430.00 per liter**.
- *Alternative*: **Clear Out** or **Spitfire** (~₱400.00/L). Use for "blanket spraying" before the cane sprouts.
- **2,4-D Amine/Ester**: **₱300.00 – ₱325.00 per liter**.
- *Application*: Selective for broadleaf weeds. Safe to spray over standing cane if weeds are small.
- **Atrazine**: **₱350.00 – ₱450.00 per kg**.
- *Usage*: Best pre-emergence herbicide. Apply right after planting/off-barring to prevent weed seeds from germinating.

GoEden +3

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3. Insecticides & Fungicides (per Liter/Pack)

- **Prevathon (Borer Control)**: **₱1,200.00 – ₱1,500.00 per 250ml** (Concentrated).
- *Why*: It is the "gold standard" for stem borers in Bukidnon.
- **Zulpac (Lambda-cyhalothrin)**: **₱450.00 – ₱600.00 per liter**.
- *Usage*: Good for general sucking insects and armyworms.
- **Zerin (Benomyl Fungicide)**: **₱650.00 per kg**.

- *Purpose*: Used for treating setts before planting to prevent Pineapple disease and Red Rot.

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4. Foliars, Boosters & Adjuvants

- **Nutrio Foliar**: **₱350.00 per 100g**.
- *Alternative*: **Super Gro** (~₱2,500/L but highly concentrated). These act as "vitamins" for the plant during drought or after heavy rains.
- **Sticker/Spreader (e.g., S-800)**: **₱150.00 – ₱250.00 per liter**.
- *Importance*: Do not skip this! Bukidnon rains can wash away your chemicals in minutes; stickers ensure the medicine stays on the leaf.

Facebook +3

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Where to Buy in Bukidnon

For the best prices, check the agrivet cluster in **Valencia City** (near the Public Market) or the large distributors along the highway in **Maramag**. Many stores offer a "Planter's Discount" if you show your **ABSFI** or **USPBA** membership ID.

Based on the current 2026 prices in **Valencia** and **Maramag**, here is a breakdown of the estimated input costs for **one hectare** of sugarcane. This assumes a high-yield target of 80–100 tons (TC/ha) for a **Ratoon Crop**, which is common in Bukidnon.

1. Fertilizer Cost (The "Big Three")

For a productive ratoon, you typically need **10–12 bags** of fertilizer per hectare.

Fertilizer Type	Quantity	Unit Price	Total Cost
Complete (14-14-14)	4 Bags	₱1,500.00	₱6,000.00
Urea (46-0-0)	6 Bags	₱1,800.00	₱10,800.00
Potash (0-0-60)	2 Bags	₱1,500.00	₱3,000.00

Subtotal	**₱19,800.00**

2. Chemical Control (Herbicides & Pesticides)

Assuming a standard weed and borer prevention program.

Chemical Item	Quantity	Unit Price	Total Cost
Atrazine (Pre-emergence)	2 kg	₱400.00	₱800.00
2,4-D Ester (Broadleaf)	2 Liters	₱315.00	₱630.00
Roundup/Glyphosate	4 Liters	₱430.00	₱1,720.00
Prevathon (Borer Control)	500 ml	₱2,800.00	₱2,800.00
Sticker/Spreader	1 Liter	₱250.00	₱250.00
Subtotal			**₱6,200.00**

3. Boosters & Foliars (Optional but Recommended)

To push the tonnage and help the plant recover from "stress" (drought or heavy rain).

Item	Quantity	Unit Price	Total Cost
Nutrio Foliar	4 Packs	₱350.00	₱1,400.00
Bio-N (Inoculant)	5 Packs	₱100.00	₱500.00
Subtotal			**₱1,900.00**

Estimated Total Input Cost per Hectare: ₱27,900.00

Important Notes for Bukidnon Planters:

- **Labor Costs (Not Included)**: You must add roughly **₱35,000 – ₱45,000** for labor (shaving, weeding, fertilizing, and harvesting/hauling) to get your total "pocket" expense.
- **Bulk Discount**: If you buy your 12 bags of fertilizer all at once from a major dealer like **Agway in Valencia**, you can usually negotiate a **₱20–₱50 discount per bag**, saving you up to ₱600.

- **The "Profit" Math**:
- Total Cost (Inputs + Labor): **~₱70,000**.
- Potential Gross (at 100 Lkg/ha and ₱2,175/Lkg): **₱217,500**.
- **Estimated Net Profit**: **~₱147,500 per hectare** (before milling deductions).

To maximize your yield in Bukidnon, you need to sync your spending with the **milling cycle** (usually September to May). If you harvest in **November**, your "Month 1" for the ratoon crop begins in **December**.
Here is a 12-month budget timeline for **one hectare**, showing when the cash leaves your pocket:

Phase 1: The "Wake Up" (Months 1–2)

Focus: Cleaning the field and starting new roots.

- **Month 1 (Dec):**
- **Labor:** Stubble shaving and trash manual moving (**₱3,500**).
- **Inputs:** 2kg Atrazine + 1L Sticker (**₱1,050**).
- **Month 2 (Jan):**
- **Labor:** Off-barring (plowing) and first weeding (**₱4,000**).
- **Inputs:** 4 bags Complete (14-14-14) + 5 packs Bio-N (**₱6,500**).
- **Total Phase 1: ₱15,050**

Phase 2: The "Growth Spike" (Months 3–5)

Focus: Producing "Tillers" (more stalks per clump).

- **Month 3 (Feb):**
- **Labor:** First Top-dress application (**₱1,500**).
- **Inputs:** 3 bags Urea (**₱5,400**).
- **Month 4 (Mar):**
- **Labor:** Spot weeding and spray application (**₱2,000**).
- **Inputs:** 2L 2,4-D + 250ml Prevathon (**₱2,030**).
- **Month 5 (Apr):**
- **Labor:** On-barring and Hilling-up (**₱3,000**).

- **Inputs:** 3 bags Urea + 2 bags Potash (**₱8,400**).
- **Total Phase 2: ₱22,330**

Phase 3: Maintenance (Months 6–9)

Focus: Protecting the "Grand Growth" phase from pests.

- **Month 6 (May):**
- **Labor:** Detrashing (Lulid) – removing dead leaves (**₱4,000**).
- **Month 7 (Jun):**
- **Inputs:** 4 packs Nutrio Foliar + 250ml Prevathon (**₱2,800**).
- **Month 8-9 (Jul-Aug):**
- **Labor:** Field monitoring and minor drainage work (**₱2,000**).
- **Total Phase 3: ₱8,800**

Phase 4: Harvest & Hauling (Month 12)

Focus: Getting the cane to BUSCO or Crystal.

- **Month 12 (Nov):**
- **Labor:** Cutting and Loading (**₱250 - ₱300 per ton**). For 80 tons = **₱24,000**.
- **Logistics:** Trucking/Hauling (varies by distance). Approx. **₱15,000**.
- **Total Phase 4: ₱39,000**

Financial Summary (Per Hectare)

- **Pre-Harvest Spending (Months 1-9): ₱46,180**
- **Harvest Costs (Month 12): ₱39,000**
- **Grand Total Expense: ₱85,180**

The "Bukidnon Planter" Strategy:

Most farmers in Bukidnon use their **Molasses Dividends** or **Rebates** from the *previous* crop to fund Phase 1. For Phase 2 (the most expensive part), many apply for a **Production Loan** from their Planters' Association (ABSFI/USPBA) or LandBank to cover the fertilizer costs.